ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/12: Visible apex and managed strain

VISIBLE CAPACITY -> revenue claim, armies, court, capital and monuments
MANAGED STRAIN -> growing rank claims meet uneven realised revenue
COURT SPLENDOUR -> evidence of coordination, not universal prosperity
MONTH-RATING -> adaptation inside a functioning order, not final collapse
VERDICT -> an imperial apex carrying an expanding claim-resource mismatch.
MUST REMEMBER: Shah Jahan (1628-58) governed through a changing mansab-jagir elite whose composition and costs require analysis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/12: Shah Jahan chronology, 1628-58

```
1628 -> accession after a courtly succession settlement
1633 / 1636 -> Ahmadnagar ends; Bijapur-Golconda framework follows
1638 -> Shahjahanabad foundation and capital-making process
1646-47 -> Balkh venture | 1649-53 -> Qandahar loss and failed recovery
1656-57 -> renewed Deccan pressure | 1657 -> imperial illness
1658 -> Dharmat and Samugarh; sovereignty is violently reconfigured.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/12: The ruling class as a composite service elite

```
CENTRE -> emperor distributes rank, honour, command and revenue claims
SERVICE ELITE -> mansabdars link court access to military-administrative duty
GROUP LABELS -> Turani, Irani, Hindustani, Rajput, Afghan and Deccani overlap
LOCAL LINKS -> houses, clients and regional networks add capacity and leverage
SAFE CLAIM -> diversity widened; no percentage without date and denominator.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/12: Recruitment, reproduction and faction

```
ENTRY -> competence, recommendation, household service and imperial favour
FORMAL RULE -> mansab is appointed, transferable and not automatically hereditary
SOCIAL FACT -> kin, clients, training and reputation reproduce advantage
FACTION -> shifting patronage coalition, not a permanent ethnic voting bloc
PRESSURE -> promotion and good jagirs intensify competition around princes.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/12: Mansabdari evolution and verification

```
ALAUDDIN / SHER SHAH -> earlier branding and descriptive controls
AKBAR -> mature mansab; zat status-pay and sawar cavalry obligation
JAHANGIR -> du-aspa sih-aspa raises specified cavalry duty, not zat
SHAH JAHAN -> context-bound contingent ratios and closer claim management
CONTROL LIMIT -> nominal rank, inspected muster and field strength can diverge.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/12: Jagir vocabulary: claim is not ownership

```
JAGIR -> transferable assignment of a state revenue claim for service
JAGIRDAR -> imperial assignee | ZAMINDAR -> locally rooted, variable intermediary
KHALISA -> revenue retained for the crown
JAMA -> assessed or estimated claim | HASIL -> realised collection
WATAN -> hereditary-local association in context, not an ordinary transferable jagir
TRAP -> none of these terms is simply modern private landownership.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/12: How the month-scale worked

```
NOMINAL JAMA -> jagir appears to support twelve months of entitlement
REALISATION TEST -> war, control, survey and collection reduce usable return
MONTH RATING -> twelve becomes eight, six, five, four or less in context
ADJUSTMENT -> salary and sawar obligation scale to effective yield
POLITICAL EFFECT -> pressure for better assignments, patrons and collection
TRAP -> month-rating is a reduction device, not a bonus.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/12: From paper rank to effective force

```
HIGHER MANSAB CLAIMS -> larger salary and cavalry obligations
UNEQUAL JAGIR YIELD -> nominal jama exceeds realised hasil
SHORT RATING -> pay, remounts and contingent support are compressed
ELITE RESPONSE -> bargaining, patronage competition or harder local extraction
STATE RESPONSE -> transfer, muster, ratio rules and fresh assignments
VERDICT -> recurring management reveals strain without proving collapse.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/12: Expansion creates resources and claimants

```
DECCAN GAINS -> forts, tribute claims, routes and assessed revenue
NEW COSTS -> garrisons, commanders, transport, remounts and collection friction
BALKH -> tactical capacity without durable retention
QANDAHAR -> mobilisation cannot overcome every siege and supply constraint
VERDICT -> map expansion and fiscal realisation must be tested separately.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/12: Grandeur as political economy

```
MONUMENTS / CAPITAL -> coordinate labour, workshops, materials and transport
SOVEREIGNTY -> court, fort, mosque, tomb and city make hierarchy visible
URBAN DEMAND -> artisans and suppliers can benefit from concentrated consumption
AGRARIAN BASE -> revenue extraction and distribution remain unequal
TRAP -> splendour is neither a treasury balance nor proof of universal welfare
TRAP -> monuments alone did not cause Mughal decline.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Architecture, including the Taj Mahal, is evidence of patronage and
  resources but not a substitute for ruling-class study.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/12: Succession as a ruling-class stress test

```
TRIGGER 1657 -> illness creates uncertainty without primogeniture
PRINCES -> Dara, Shuja, Aurangzeb and Murad command regional-household bases
NOBLES -> choose through access, survival, command and expected reward
1658 -> Dharmat and Samugarh shift control of the imperial centre
RESULT -> institutions persist while their sovereign command is violently reassigned
TRAP -> faction is not ethnicity and war is not instant state collapse.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: The 1657 succession crisis arose within dynastic and fiscal structures; it was
  not governed by primogeniture.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/12: Topic 21 final answer spine

```
OPEN -> visible imperial apex plus managed claim-resource strain
DEFINE -> ruling class, mansab, jagir, jama, hasil and month-rating
TRACE -> composite recruitment -> expanding claims -> uneven realisation
PROVE -> Deccan/frontier costs, capital-making and the 1657-58 stress test
QUALIFY -> no false percentages, monument ledger or inevitable-collapse story
VERDICT -> high capacity adapted to pressure but did not eliminate it.
```